

Field kit — Hakuba Happo-One

30-second table · Happo bed · logistics · 7-night spine · Book this

HUB 2 — Hakuba Happo-One

This week in 30 seconds

	Do this
Sleep	Maruishi or Shiroumaso for inn Japanese dinner. Bar-hop every night? THE HAPPO .
Shape	~5 nights Happo + ~2 nights Nozawa — you move
Arrive	Narita or Haneda → Nagano Snow Shuttle → Happo BT → walk
Out	NSS from Nozawa Chuo → Haneda or Narita. Do not go back to Happo .
Days	Ski the valley. Soak. Walk to dinner. Decide tomorrow on japowsearch
Soak	Happo-no-Yu after the hill — high-alkaline municipal, tattoo OK.
Money	Beds + airport coaches ~\$1,600–\$2,200 / person (group of 4). Not the week total — lifts, meals, Happo→Nozawa, bags extra

Do	Don't
Book the airport shuttle to Happo BT	Sleep in Nagano city and day-trip Hakuba
Book Maruishi or Shiroumaso for inn Japanese dinner. Bar-hop every night? THE HAPPO	Sleep in Echoland / Wadano — too far from Happo BT for the 8 a.m. valley buses
Ask the inn to skip dinner if you walk out some nights	Book those two if every night is drinks out — dinner is in the rate
Stay 10 min of Happo BT. Move to Nozawa two nights	Day-trip Nozawa from Happo
Book the outbound NSS from Nozawa Chuo when you book inbound. The coach does not wait for your flight.	Go back to Happo for the airport bus. Book a tight flight after the Nozawa coach — highway snow can stop it.
Buy HV lift tickets online the night before	Drive without studless tires (スタッドレス)
If you rent: reserve hotel parking first	Arrive by car without a reserved hotel parking space
After ski: Happo-no-Yu before dinner (tattoo OK)	Treat hotel baths as the municipal FAQ — ask the desk
Walk or ride the night bus after dinner	Drink and drive — in Japan that is a serious crime

Hakuba Valley is a **major inbound name**, so it draws a crowd. Powder mornings here track out faster than on a quiet local hill.

What still outweighs that: several mountains without a car, a municipal soak after the lifts, a walkable night, and one bus knot that holds a car-free week together.

This chapter is for a week of skiing, a soak, and nights out.

Sleep at **Happo Bus Terminal**. Stay inside about a **10-minute walk**. Echoland is the louder night; Wadano is quieter. Treat either as an evening, not as the bed.

Then you **move**. If you have never stayed in **Nozawa Onsen**, go—even though it is a major name too. Happo-One is the home port. Nozawa is Act 2.

Stay next to **Happo Bus Terminal**. The airport coach is the **Nagano Snow Shuttle**. Daytime valley buses are free on the Hakuba Valley network.

Mountain	How (from Happo BT)	Why go
Happo-One	Walk, or free HV Line H / E	Home hill. Ridge wind-holds. No nighter.
Iwatake	Free HV · ~15 min	Weekday trees / leftover afternoon powder
Hakuba 47 / Goryu	Free HV south (watch the link)	Linked domain. Goryu Waves on lean days. Night lights: Toomi.
Tsugaike	Free HV Line T	Acreage. DBD: watch the lecture tonight
Cortina / Norikura	Paid Line V unless HV pass	Deep trees. Not a free hop.
Nozawa Onsen	NSS inter-resort	Act 2 — two nights, not a day trip

Wind: Happo ridge gondolas and the 47–Goryu link shut in strong wind. Pick tomorrow’s hill every night on [japowsearch](#).

The mountain you sleep under is the hub, not every day’s hill. Ski the valley from Happo Bus Terminal; then move to Nozawa for two nights.

Choose the week: eat out, or dinner at the inn

Maruishi and Shiroumaso will not show on Booking.com. English book is Trip.com. Confirm dinner is on the Trip.com plan.

Japanese: Maruishi [happo.jp](#) · 0261-72-2116; [Trip.com Maruishi](#).
 Shiroumaso [shiroumaso.com](#) · 0261-72-2121; [Trip.com Shiroumaso](#).

These two are **ryokan rates**: dinner is in the price. That is the point. If every night is drinks and a walk-out restaurant, do **not** make them the default — use [THE HAPPO](#), Moegi, or Panorama.

If you want **Japanese food at the inn**, Maruishi or Shiroumaso is the main bed for this chapter.

You can still walk out some nights. **Ask the inn** to skip dinner (room-only / no-dinner) before you book, or at check-in. Do not assume Trip.com already did that.

This guide’s call: dinner here will usually beat the tourist-menu rooms around Happo BT. That is why these two sit first.

Walking to dinner every night, or you need an English desk? [THE HAPPO](#).

Ski-access first? Moegi. Taproom downstairs? Panorama. All still inside about a **10-minute walk** of Happo BT.

Stay	Walk	Why this one	Shared hotel bath	Book
Maruishi (まるいし)	~5 min	Inn Japanese dinner. Local. Official kakenagashi. Almost no English.	Yes — flow-through. Tattoo: ask inn . Reserved tatami bath ¥2,100 / hr	Trip.com · happo.jp · 0261-72-2116
Shiroumaso (しろうま荘)	~2 min	Inn Japanese dinner. Local food. Village listing: Happo Onsen kakenagashi.	Yes . Tattoo: ask inn .	Trip.com · shiroumaso.com · 0261-72-2121
THE HAPPO	~3 min	Eat out every night. English desk. One knot for airport, valley, Nozawa bus.	Yes — ask desk	the-happo.com
Hakuba Moegi HOTEL	~8 min	Ski-access first. 10 rooms.	No — soak at Happo-no-Yu	hotelmoegi.com · 489ban
Hakuba Panorama Hotel	~5 min	Standard + Taproom downstairs.	Yes — ask desk	tenguproperties.com

Hotel shared baths: house tattoo rule is **not on the hotel sites** — ask the desk. Maruishi and Shiroumaso the same. Need a published yes? Walk to **Happo-no-Yu**

(municipal, tattoo OK). Maruishi winter: no hotel shuttle (you walk). THE HAPPO band: ¥60,000–¥110,000+ / night (twin)—not a rack. Moegi / Panorama: enter dates on the official engine. [Confirm for 2026–27](#)

Online compare: enter your dates once and [quote the Happo BT shortlist](#) on one page (Agoda, Booking, Trip.com where listed). Official hotel links stay in the table — use them if the rate is close, especially **Maruishi** and **Shiroumaso** ryokan plans.

Book a Happo bed

Book on the links above. Each one is its own engine. Inn meals in English: **Trip.com** — confirm meals on the plan. Japanese: happo.jp / shiroumaso.com / phone.

If those are gone: book another hotel still inside a **10-minute walk** of Happo BT.

Stay	Walk	What it is	Book
Hotel Goryukan	~8 min	Local hotel, ~38 rooms, Happo Onsen + sauna. Best “more rooms” backup. Winter 2026–27: 5 nights+ now; 1-night ~November.	Village desk · goryukan.jp
Hakuba Hifumi	~5 min	Japanese inn, 13 rooms, Happo Onsen. Not a chain.	hakubahifumi.jp
Happo-kan	Happo Onsen cluster	Economy inn, village desk, Happo Onsen bath.	Village desk
Hotel Taigakukan	Gondola ~5 min	Old Happo hotel. JTB: Happo BT ~4 min.	taigakukan.jp

Then the [village Happo-One search](#) — English, dates on. Help: Hakuba Tourism Commission **0261-85-4210**, 9:00–17:00 JST. **Happo-One is a wide net** — still a 10-minute walk to Happo BT. Not the same bed: Tokyu / Abest / Snow Peak (Wadano–Kitaone) · Courtyard / La Vigne (Echoland) · Hotel Hakuba (station side). If Happo walk is empty, those are a different trip — taxi or shuttle every morning. Do not start on happo.net lift packs — paused.

How you get here

Plan A — one coach. Land at Haneda or Narita. Book [Nagano Snow Shuttle](#) in advance. Sit until it stops at **Happo Bus Terminal**. Walk to the hotel. You do not change trains. You do not go to Nagano Station.

Ride	You pay (2025–26)	What you are buying
Haneda → Happo BT	¥14,025 (extra bag ¥2,200)	~5 hr · the whole airport-to-hotel ride
Narita → Happo BT	¥15,125 (same bags)	~5–6 hr · same, from Narita
Happo → Nozawa (later)	¥7,150 (+ Zone A ¥1,375 ≈ ¥8,525)	The move . First bus if you want afternoon ski.
Nozawa Chuo → Haneda	¥13,750	~6–7 hr · fly out from Nozawa. How: Act 2 Out.
Nozawa Chuo → Narita	¥14,850 (night run costs more)	~6–7 hr · allow 3 hours at the airport after arrival.

[Confirm for 2026–27](#) fares, clock, and winter dates when the season page goes live. Outbound is the same operator the other way — book it with inbound. Snow buffer and Liner backup: Act 2 Out.

Plan B — only if Plan A is sold out. Not a cheaper airport ride. Three tickets:

- 1. Airport train into Tokyo.

2. **Shinkansen** Tokyo → Nagano Station (separate ticket; ski bags through the city).
3. **Alpico Nagano-Hakuba** — Nagano Station East Exit → Hakuba Happo Bus Terminal (same Happo BT as NSS). Winter 2025–26 adult ¥3,500. Many buses a day; pick one on that timetable. Winter: some runs need a web reservation (30 min before); others are same-day walk-up. No toilet on board. [Confirm on the 2026–27 winter timetable](#) — the page now shows Apr–Nov; winter usually posts mid-November.

Use Plan B as a backup, not as the plan. The ¥3,500 is Nagano → Happo, not Haneda → Happo.

Once you are at Happo

Daytime shuttles to Happo-One / Iwatake / Tsugaike are mostly **free**. Cortina is the exception: Line V ¥800 unless you already have a Hakuba Valley lift pass. Night bus is with dinner.

Ski bags: TA-Q-BIN airport → hotel ~¥2,500 / bag. Keep boots on you. Fair weather is usually **next day**. Snow / storm days can take 2–3 days. At the airport counter, **ask which arrival day they are quoting** — do not assume tomorrow. Yamato does not let you pick a delivery date on ski bags to a hotel. **Lift tickets:** buy Hakuba Valley [online the night before](#). Do not buy in the morning maze. [How-to](#).

Optional — rental car

Built **without** a car. Rent only for Cortina on your clock, or four adults splitting a van after a dump. Drinking and driving in Japan is a **serious crime**—not “dangerous,” not a fine you shake off. If you go out, you do not drive.

If you do rent, **book at the airport you land**, then drive to Happo (allow ~5 hr in winter). That **replaces** the Nagano Snow Shuttle. It is not an extra on top of Plan A.

Must — hotel parking, both stays. Happo and Nozawa inn lots are small. **Reserve a space with the hotel before you pick up the car** — Happo and Nozawa. Street parking in the village is not the backup. If either inn says full, you do not have a car plan. This is hotel parking, not the Happo-One ski-area lot.

Must — studless tires (スタッドレス). 4WD is not enough. Confirm **studless** on the booking screen **and** at pickup: look at the tires before you leave the lot. Airport cars often come on summer or all-season rubber unless you tick winter (sometimes extra). Chains in the trunk are not a substitute.

Book: [Discover Cars — Haneda \(HND\)](#) · [Discover Cars — Narita \(NRT\)](#). Winter 4WD is not the \$23 banner. [Confirm for 2026–27](#)

Class (4WD + studless, Dec–Mar)	About 7 days	(per day)
Compact	¥75,000–¥90,000	~¥11,000–¥13,000
SUV / wagon	¥105,000–¥135,000	~¥15,000–¥19,000
Minivan (6–8 seats)	¥125,000–¥155,000	~¥18,000–¥22,000

7 nights — Happo then Nozawa

Five nights in a Happo-walk bed. Then you **move**. Two nights in Nozawa. Fly out the next morning — **8 calendar days, 7 nights**.

Tonight (every Happo night except the last): japowsearch.com → wind on the Happo ridge → weather table → first bus you can board. This table is for **no car, Happo BT**. If Cortina tomorrow, buy Line V tonight and confirm that morning's bus is running. If tomorrow is Tsugaike trees, watch the [TSUGA POW DBD lecture](#) tonight — the gate will not wait while you watch it at the summit.

If tonight looks like...	Go tomorrow
Deep new snow + high wind	Tsugaike (free Line T). Cortina only if that morning's shuttle is running. Buses dead → Nakiyama.
Bluebird after the dump	Happo-One ridge — if those lifts open. First chairs.
Rain / thaw in the village	Go high (Happo / Tsugaike / Goryu Alps Daira). Shade: 47 . Not Toomi.
No new snow	Goryu Waves only in season (2025–26: 31 Jan–late Mar). Else Happo groomers.
Weekend + fresh snow	Norikura or Tsugaike. Skip Happo and Cortina. Iwatake = afternoon leftover.

Days 3–5 are **not** a locked tour of Iwatake → Cortina → 47. The weather table wins. The week table below is only for a midweek week with no storm. Evening jobs are scarce: **do not stack Hie and Goryu night skiing**. **Do not night-ski the night you land or the night you pack**.

Tsugaike DBD is not “show up and ski trees.” Groomers need nothing extra. The gated powder (TSUGA POW DBD) needs: (1) the official lecture video **before you ride the gondola** — tsugaike.gr.jp/snow/gelände/tsugapow; (2) waiver + **armband** at **Kitchen Tsuga-no-mori** (formerly Jacky's Kitchen), 2F Eve gondola summit; (3) the armband on your arm or the gate stays shut. 18+. **Area closes 14:00**. Patrol can keep it closed that morning. Do the desk on a quiet day if you can. [Confirm the 2026–27 hours](#)

	Daytime	Evening — one job
1 • Arrive Happo	NSS → Happo BT. Nakiyama only if before ~16:00. After dark: bags + hotel onsen (ask desk) or Happo-no-Yu (tattoo OK).	Ohyokkuri or hotel. No Echoland.
2 • Happo	Happo-One (home hill).	Happo-walk dinner (Ohyokkuri / Taproom).
3 • Happo	Weather table. If the night is quiet: leftover Iwatake .	Happo-no-Yu from ~16:00 → change → Hie (Line VN). Not night skiing tonight.
4 • Happo	Weather table. Quiet: Tsugaike (Cortina only if Line V is running).	Goryu night skiing <i>or</i> Happo walk. Not Hie again.
5 • Happo	Weather table. Quiet: 47 or Waves if that season is on.	Pack . Happo-no-Yu (tattoo OK). No Echoland.
6 • Move → Nozawa	First NSS Happo → Chuo BT. Early bus: 4-hour ticket (¥6,400). Late bus: baths only.	Booked dinner 19:30+. Ōyu if legs (tattoo OK).
7 • Nozawa	In-bounds, or Canyons for trees. Wind-hold: village.	Early. Kuma-no-tearai-yu (tattoo OK).
8 • Out	NSS Nozawa Chuo → Narita / Haneda. Do not return to Happo.	—

Lights — three hills, not the same product.

Happo-One has **no night skiing**. Stay off the mountain **17:00–07:30** (groomer cables). Iwatake, Tsugaike, and 47: none.

Goryu calls itself Hakuba village's only nighter.

Hill	When	Hours	From Happo BT
ABLE Hakuba Goryu — Toomi (Iimori some nights)	2025–26: most nights 27 Dec–19 Mar (closed 4 Mar 2026). Confirm for 2026–27	18:00–21:30	The default. Adult night ticket ¥6,500 . Day / HV pass does not cover it. Nighter page
Cortina — Ike-no-ta	2026–27 confirmed. Selected dates only: 26 Dec–2 Jan, 10 Jan, and Jan/Feb Saturdays	17:00–21:00	Do not from Happo BT. Line V dies after the daytime buses.
Nozawa — Nagasaka	2025–26: selected dates only — 27 Dec–3 Jan daily, then Saturdays 10 Jan–21 Mar (+ 11 Jan, 22 Feb, 20 Mar)	Day close– 20:00	Act 2 only. Village shuttle to Nagasaka. Not every village night. Adult ¥2,700 .

Goryu FAQ: free night shuttle to Escal Plaza — [Confirm on the 2026–27 timetable](#). **Line VN bans skis** (Echoland dinner bus, not a nighter bus).
Taxi backup. Do not drink and then drive.

Kikyo-ya is station sushi, not a Happo walk. Grindel is lunch only.

Book this

You already chose Eat out or Inn dinner. Do not re-pick here.

August (first day 2026–27 winter inquiries open): Happo — **Maruishi** or **Shiroumaso** if you eat at the inn (English [Trip.com Maruishi](#) / [Trip.com Shiroumaso](#); Japanese [happo.jp](#) / [shiroumaso.com](#)). Eat out / English desk? THE HAPPO, Moegi, or Panorama on their own engines. If gone: [village Happo-One search](#) — still a 10-minute Happo BT walk. Nozawa: book via **both** official desks — [Tourism Bureau 489ban calendar](#) and [Ryokan Association form](#). Named boutiques opened in May; if they are gone, do not wait for OTAs. No room on either desk → drop Act 2 and stay Happo seven nights.

90 days: Maruishi or Shiroumaso (inn meals) or THE HAPPO (eat out / English). NSS airport + Happo–Nozawa + **Nozawa→airport**. Happo dinner list and **Nozawa dinner list** (Suminoya / one more). If car path: **reserve parking at both inns**.

30 days: HV lift ticket online. Remaining TableCheck. Tell the Nozawa inn your NSS arrival time (bags). Car only if you chose it (**studless on the voucher · parking held at both inns**).

14–7 days: Sakaya-class cancellations. [japowsearch](#) sketch. If Hie is booked, save the night-bus page. If you want Tsugaike trees, watch the [TSUGA POW DBD video](#) once. Reconfirm Nozawa dinner.

Happo is the English-easy valley: the hill and the night street are a walk from the same bus knot, and the other Hakuba mountains come to you. Nozawa trades that circuit for one long hill and soto-yu after ski. Stay the two nights. Do not day-trip the second.

Full guide (bookmark):

<https://japowsearch.com/guide/hsgcvg2cv79dy4pv9djka363/>

Free updates through May 31, 2027. Do not share the full-guide URL publicly.

